

Stronger than the Internet Connectivity: A Phenomenology

Mary Ann P. Bahinting*, Melca P. Ardiente, Jenevic E. Endona, Mary Abiguel A. Herapat, Darell C. Lambo, Hanalyn Joy A. Librea, Marianne Claire Y. Librando, Jean Bernadette B. Libron, Mary Jolina Petaluna, Gracelyn C. Ygot, Jingoy D. Taneo, Cyril A. Cabello, Antonieta V. Minyamin

For affiliations and correspondence, see the last page.

Abstract

Internet connectivity becomes the life of every student in the Higher Education Institutions (HEI) when the educational sector was affected by the pandemic. Every college student desires to have stable internet connectivity in order to sustain education despite the different challenges. This study aims to explicate the student's experiences in a blended learning modality having poor internet connectivity. This paper is grounded on Theory of Attribution, which highlighted the factors affecting students' education in online learning, which was started by Fritz Heider on his works in 1958. The study employed a qualitative approach that utilizes Heideggerian Phenomenology and Interpretative Phenomenological Analysis (IPA) anchored on the Modified Van Kaam Approach popularized by Moustakas. There were 10 participants included in this study who qualified under the inclusion criteria using purposive sampling. The findings of the study enumerated 5 emerging themes: (1) The Resources, (2) The Usage, (3) The Impediment, (4) The Initiative, and (5) The End Results. These themes highlighted Cebu Technological University - Moalboal Campus college students' experiences with poor internet connectivity in the new online learning modality. It is recommended that since the internet serves as a potent instrument for online learning, the university may create a management plan that can augment the unstable internet connection experienced by college students.

Keywords: Internet Connectivity, Phenomenology, Blended Learning, Pandemic

Introduction

The impacts of the Covid pandemic on the educational system, particularly in higher education, are not limited to the country where the virus originated, with over a hundred countries throughout the world experiencing these repercussions (Toquero, 2020). Due to the nature of this health crisis, the higher education institutions in the Philippines are taking a huge leap by switching to blended learning modality to cope with this pandemic (Abel, 2020). Amid lockdowns and quarantines, utilizing online learning is one advantageous and effective option to deliver quality education (Abumalloh et al., 2020). Online learning poses a major challenge to developing countries like the Philippines during a pandemic, despite the boons (Rotas & Cahapay, 2020). Although studies reveal the opposing sides of online learning, there are no adequate works of literature that highlights the specific effect of signal strength or lack of thereof during online learning. This study investigates student challenges regarding the transition from traditional classrooms to digital learning. Numerous concerns have emerged due to the shift from the conventional to online mode of learning, such as the deprivation of face-to-face interaction between students and teachers (Adnan & Anwar, 2020). Those who are already disadvantaged, on the other hand, are experiencing increased digital exclusion as a result of

poor internet connectivity. The consequences of the pandemic perilously plummeted like an avalanche, affecting sectors including education, which temporarily shut down due to lockdowns and quarantines. Students from all levels took the hit hard, with some of them completely stopping school altogether. Internet access and technical devices, or lack thereof, were among the top challenges in the new mode of learning. In the Philippine context, various studies have revealed some conflicting feelings regarding the utilization of devices and internet access. Following the logic of exception, one of the responses of global education systems amidst the pandemic has been their subtle switch to 'emergency e-learning' protocols, directing the fast transition of offline classes to online learning modalities without proper planning and testing if it would be effective or not (Murphy, 2020). The COVID-19 pandemic has brought significant challenges for the Higher Education Institution (HEI) to maintain quality and performance. The spread of COVID-19 has also changed the pattern of social interaction on a massive scale globally and eventually influenced how the organization operates, (Tahar et al., 2022). Based on research developed by (R Ilmi, et al 2021) regarding e-modules that can be operated on Android-based smartphones, that e-modules are valid, practical, and effective in learning. (Serevina et al., 2022).

In online learning, the problem of internet connectivity

is one of the obstacles students have to face (Fabito et al., 2020). Learning is hindered for students who have limited access to the internet (Casillano, 2019). Similarly, ownership of devices like computers and access to the internet is inadequate for students who belong to a lower socioeconomic status (Cleofas & Rocha, 2021). However, it is possible to improve the utilization of mobile devices in education (Jin & Sabio, 2018). Correspondingly, there is a substantial influence on a student's learning preparedness when one has owned a number of devices (Estira, 2020). In addition, the cost of computers and internet connections appears to be a challenge for students despite their readiness for online learning (Yra et al., 2020). Amid the sudden shift from physical to online learning, the challenge of slow internet connections in the Philippines continues to loom over (Azcarra & Peña, 2019). In order to construct effective approaches toward online learning, pondering and reflecting upon the student's journey and looking at things from their perspective in this new normal of education is one effective step to take (Aguilar & Torres, 2021). Although, it has long been generally been identified that online education methods are an efficient tool for learning. As a contrary, some students may consider online learning problematic with the reason of lack of nonverbal communication, face to face interaction, material accessibility and time management, that really influence online education students' attitude.

The purpose of this study is to highlight the obstacles being faced by the students due to poor internet connectivity and how it affects their academic performance and also to raise awareness that this new mode of learning has a downside that makes the academic lives of those students that are in the lower bracket of the society harder. This article also showcases database that can be of good reference for the Higher Education Institutions (HEI) to formulate essential action plans in helping the students who are challenged and struggling in the new learning modality of teaching.

Research Questions

The study aims to explicit the experiences of students with their internet connectivity. Furthermore, this distinctively identify their challenges and answer the following questions:

1. How does the internet aid the participants' learning?
2. How does the internet usage affect in participants' tool as their sources?
3. What are the challenges participants encounter

with their internet connectivity?

4. What are the major actions taken in terms of addressing students' internet connectivity?
5. What are the effects of internet connectivity in participants' learning in online mode?
6. What will be the students approach to their academic journey amid the dilemmas concerning about their internet connectivity?

Literature Review

Internet has become a backbone of education as the delivery of lesson shifted from conventional to online learning due to the pandemic. In this new mode of learning, the academic performance is influenced on how fast or how sufficient the internet connectivity is. Intellectual capacity is not enough to cope with this new modality. Students who do not have an internet connection at home have poor grades, less enjoyment of school, lower self-esteem, lower digital skills, less interest in STEM-related careers, and in pursuing higher education opportunities. You may be at a disadvantage (Hampton et al., 2010).

Michigan State University's Quello Center stated that, slow internet connectivity or lack of accessibility from rural residences can contribute to pupils falling behind academically. Students who lack internet access or rely only on their cell phones perform half a grade point lower than those who do. Published articles and studies are examined and elaborate on this part to elucidate how students are faring in this new online learning modality adapted by their university in regards to the strength of their internet connection. Stakeholders and management of higher educational institutions have no other option but to make use of internet technology, thus online learning for the continuation of academic activities across all schools worldwide, (Demuyakor, 2020). To cope with these problems, students actively dealt with the situation by seeking help from their teachers and relatives and engaging in recreational activities. These active-oriented coping mechanisms of students were aligned with (Carter et al., 2020), who explored students' self-regulation strategies. These utilized and featured articles are being closely looked into and are meticulously assessed by the researchers. The situation of students during online classes relative to their internet provider is being weighed. The effects of their signal strength on their performance and how students feel when the signal is interrupted, as well as the general fact of poor signal strength in the Philippines. Qualitative research is being used to explain the certain side of the students in this current learning

modality.

The Corona Virus negatively affects the educational system. As this result in numerous countries resorted to the closing of academic institutions in order to lessen or decrease the expansion of the virus that causes the numerous challenges that not only teachers but also students are facing. In order to mobilize the education system, they have decided to use a flexible type of learning and started to use the internet to continue the teaching and learning process. Some platforms are used including Google meet, Zoom, Google classroom, Facebook, YouTube, and other instructional platforms. People used the internet mostly for social networking before the Covid-19-induced outbreak, especially here in the Philippines. In a similar way, students and teachers tend to use cellular data for social networking. Later, the faculty members perceive the social networking site as one of the most accessible media to communicate with the students (Rabbi et al., 2020). The use of the Internet for university education was severely restricted within these parameters. The pandemic has drastically altered the situation in the current pandemic-induced reality, and the government has embraced global best practices to combat the virus. This standard practice set includes suspicious case analysis, quarantine and isolation of infected patients, local or regional lockdown, granting general leave from all offices for staying home of people, and increasing social distance is enforced through public awareness (Islam et al., 2020).

As a solution to this scenario, online learning has arrived as a potential one (Shama & Ikbali, 2020). However, this potential solution has come with several issues, including learning satisfaction. Unfortunately, financial and technological satisfactions, which are related, are posing a barrier to pedagogical success (Hossain et al., 2021). The factors impeding the success of online learning are more extended. This list includes the poor internet connection (Tabassum et al., 2021), technical framework, expensive internet, internet speed lag, family financial catastrophes, and psychological stress (Ramij & Sultana, 2020). Moreover, it is not feasible to undertake most classroom activities in an online class (AlAmin et al., 2021). Instead, internet and energy connections may not always be reliable or consistent. Other impediments include the Internet's slow speed and the difficulty of using the online platform. (Dutta & Smita, 2020). One of the consequences of those incidents is less student participation from the rural areas (Rabbi et al., 2020), while this rate is relatively high from the metropolitan areas (Islam et al., 2020). Eventually, the home environment might not support their study

concentration; and as it plays a disruptive role to concentrate on the study (Sultana, 2020).

Over the last decade, there has been an increasing awareness of the detrimental consequences of inequality in Internet access and use. Recent policy debates have focused on the "homework gap" and discrepancies in home Internet access, as well as their implications for school performance. According to Pew Research Center data from 2015, roughly five million homes with school-aged children lacked broadband Internet access at home (Horrigan, 2015). According to national data, technology is becoming more integrated into teaching and learning. Seventy percent of teachers provide homework that necessitates the use of the internet. In the United States, 30% of school districts include technology in their curriculum. According to earlier studies, high school pupils who have access to internet connectivity at home have 6-8 percentage points' greater graduation rates than kids who do not (Fairlie et al., 2010). While based on national studies, students with home Internet access do better in reading, arithmetic, and science (KewalRamani et al., 2017). Research on digital inequalities has revealed a broad range of potential effects that go beyond the ability to complete homework (Hargittai & Hinnant, 2008; Robinson et al., 2015; van Laar, van Deursen, van Dijk, & de Haan, 2017). To make online education more fruitful, preparedness, participation, and excellent classroom activities are essential (Al-Amin et al., 2021). Instead, in the long run, the online class cannot be fruitful at all (Mollah, 2020). Several solutions have been arrived at to address the anomalies mentioned above. This approach comprises enhanced connection speed, better or inexpensive internet services, and technical training (Dutta & Smita, 2020).

These reviews of related literature and studies revealed that current higher-level learning research during the pandemic focuses on the availability of the internet as a factor that influences efficient online learning. The Internet problems have been recognized as a major problem, but the details of how to have this rectified have not yet been augmented. We know that internet connectivity is a major barrier to effective learning, but we don't know how these barriers or concerns are affecting present online learning. A research gap exists because of this lack of detail in the literature. This study illustrates how the current pandemic explains and affects online learning, especially to those students who are disadvantaged and challenged by resources.

Theoretical Underpinning

The study is grounded on Attribution Theory which was started by Fritz Heider in his works in 1958, and it was further advanced by other individuals including by Bernard Weiner in 1974. Attribution Theory gives emphasis on the types, namely intrinsic and extrinsic. In education, the intrinsic focuses on traits and beliefs. Extrinsic attribution, on the other hand, emphasizes the external stimuli. 4 factors are also proposed by Weiner that have direct influence on attributions, namely effort, luck, task difficulty, and ability. Furthermore, these factors are divided into three dimensions: (1) *Locus of Control*, (2) *Stability*, and (3) *Controllability*.

Education is among the fields that utilize this theory. In order to recognize the causes of a phenomenon. The failure and success of students in their education is attributed to the factors that affect them, both intrinsic and extrinsic. Considering an individual's internal or external locus of control, (Weiner et al., 1971) proposed that ability, task difficulty, effort, and luck are perhaps the most prevalent causative factors that contribute to a learner's success or failure. The causative factors of ability, task difficulty, effort, and luck can influence the outcome of an individual's behavior in different ways depending on the instructional environment. However, attribution has been widely cited in educational studies as one of the main determinants in students' learning motivation and accomplishment (Banks & Woolfson, 2008). Similarly, (Hsieh and Schallert, 2008) claim that how students interpret their prior failures can affect how they approach future performances. Students will be more motivated to improve their practices if they believe their learning failure is due to internal issues rather than external variables that they cannot control (Ellis, 2015).

Attribution Theory is being utilized in this study when the factors affecting students' education in online learning are being taken into account. The extrinsic attribution is focused specifically on the Internet as it becomes an integral part of education amid the pandemic and how students attribute the strength of their internet connectivity to the challenges they face, to their willingness to pursue their studies, and to formulate a course of actions if needs be.

Methodology

This qualitative study utilized the Heideggerian Phenomenology design. This study aims to explicate and explore the participants' lived experiences in online learning. Further, it identifies the meaning of the existence of their experience and how it can be of

great help to all policymakers in the Higher Education Institutions (HEI) in creating essential actions in sustaining quality education.

Sampling Technique

This study utilized a purposive sampling technique wherein participants were chosen to further elaborate on their experiences on internet connectivity as students of online learning method. In addition, an inclusion criterion was crafted to identify the right participants for this study. There were 10 participants included in the study.

Inclusion Criteria

1. Participants should be a student of Cebu Technological University- Moalboal Campus.
2. Participants can be in any course or program.
3. Participants can be in any year level.
4. The participants should be enrolled in this semester and attending online class.
5. Participants are identified as those who have unstable internet connection.

Data Collection

A transmittal letter was created and sent to the participants to gain their approval to conduct an interview. After gaining the participants' approval, they are set for an interview schedule through a digital platform. All participants have a Facebook account and a messenger application that the researchers used to conduct the scheduling and the interview. The sessions were recorded with the permission of the participants. A semi-structured interview guide (Smith & Shinebourne, 2012) as the instrument was made by the researchers which were approved and validated by the experts (Cabello & Bonotan, 2020). In gathering the data, the ethical consideration set in this study was strictly followed (Bryman & Bell, 2007).

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Research Rigor

The researchers utilized Whittemore et al.'s (2001) quality criteria to sustain the study's rigor. Further, these quality criteria delved more into Credibility and Authenticity; and (b) Criticality and Integrity. In addition, the rigor of this study was strengthened when the researchers performed bracketing (Cabello, 2022).

Bracketing is essential in employing impartiality and avoiding biases in the conduct of the study (Alase, 2017). All the possible answers of the participants were already anticipated (Cabello et al., 2022).

Data Analysis

This study used the Interpretative Phenomenological Analysis (IPA), which is based on Moustakas' Modified van Kaam Approach. Horizontalizing, reducing experiences to invariant constituents, thematic clustering to create core themes, comparison of multiple data sources to validate the invariant constituents, crafting individual textural descriptions, construction of composite structural descriptions, and synthesis of texture and structure into an expression are the seven key steps. (Please see Table 1. *Data Analysis* [Appendix 1])

Results and Discussion

The researchers came up with five major themes: Theme 1: The Resources, Theme 2: The Usage, Theme 3: The Impediment, Theme 4: The Take to Initiative, and Theme 5: The End Results – after analyzing the collected data.

These themes highlighted Cebu Technological University-Moalboal Campus students' experiences with poor internet connectivity in the new online learning mode.

Theme 1: The Resources

According to Dogruer, Eyyam, and Menevis (2011), For ages, the Internet has been utilized for academic goals. In other words, the Internet has been given the function of education and learning. One of today's more powerful, fully developed and expanding disciplines of education, based on the development of the Internet, is the discipline of distance learning (Moore & Kearsley, 2005). Within three years of global health crisis, online learning is the go-to option of the education system and when it comes to doing things online; internet is one of the most important resources. The statements from the participants themselves manifested this.

Participant 5 said that,

"Google, YouTube because there, I can learn almost anything in this video platform. I also visit the website of Khan Academy, Wikipedia, and as a math major, I make use of dismays graphing calculator because one

of our professors encourage us to use it, to check if our answer is correct and at the same time, in terms of research, I make use of Google scholar".

Several online sites create a massive impact on students' education and this impact is much more given significance now that there is a sudden shift due to the pandemic's nature. The availability of information from these sites makes it more advantageous for student's utilization.

Participant 6 stated that,

"Gadgets such as cellular phones, laptop and computers are some of my internet resources I use. "

The use of gadgets is not solely for entertainment purposes anymore. These gadgets connected to the internet are the main tools for students to cope with the new set up in education. These are now given merit more than it is being valued before.

The Resources theme emphasized the Internet as the main avenue for online learning. The students' need for it continuously increased as they venture their studies in this new mode of education. The Internet now served as a lifeline to sustain education amid the health crisis that has shaken the world.

Theme2: The Usage

According to Graphics, Visualization and Usability Center (1997), educational purposes are one of the first reasons for using the internet. In fact, for the first time, internet technologies hold the potential to usher in the "Age of Information" to all people of all ages, backgrounds, and economic status. Amid the global health threat, education shifted online to ensure that the teaching and learning process still persists and the internet' significance magnified now more than ever. These statements were being substantiated by the participants themselves.

Participant 3 mentioned that,

"It is quite important since we are in a new educational set-up which is the online platform of learning, so internet plays an important role for me as student to attend classes and to dig deep more about a certain topic and more that relates to this matter. "

This sentiment is shared by students in online learning. These students are not afforded with a choice of internet absence. The importance of internet now weighs more since it is being used on a daily basis,

with or without classes. The pursuit of information revolves around the internet more often than it being given credit.

Participant 5 said that,

"I use the internet to search for study-related materials; assignments, quizzes, and presentations; all study-related materials are available on the internet; and because of the internet, online education is possible. Students like me can stay on our comfort places because online classes allow us to study from home with relative ease."

One of the perks of the internet is allowing people to do their thing anywhere and for students, allowing education from home. Lock downs and quarantines prevented education to be done in a traditional setting and as a result, students need to attend classes from home. The concept of online education strengthens the notion of education revolving around the internet. When lessons are hard, there are always informed on the internet where it is being explained in a way students learn better. The availability of education-related materials 24/7 has made it easier for students to cope with the new setup.

Participant 10 mentioned,

"As a student in this new normal, internet connectivity plays a very important role because during discussion, it helps me to participate especially those professors who conduct oral discussion whom he/she gives points those who can participate."

The statement elaborated that the purpose of the internet provides great help for students, especially in their classes. Real-time discussions and meetings are possible without face-to-face setting due to the internet. Like a traditional class, professors still make sure that students can share their ideas and give corresponding points for that. And students are striving hard to participate during online synchronous meetings because, in that way, there is a greater chance of getting the grades they aspire.

The Usage theme put emphasis on how important for students to have the internet on a regular basis. Even without synchronous online meetings, the activities and assignments given by the professors were anchored online. The various textural languages drawn out from the horizons came to the conclusion that students in online classes profoundly needed the internet from time to time.

Theme3: The Impediment

The internet is nowhere near perfect and using it always has impediments. Despite the fact that internet connectivity has become essential to students' learning during the global corona virus crisis, developing countries have no access to the internet. As schools have shifted to online and remote learning, many disadvantaged or rural communities are now missing out on critical education because they do not have access to the internet. With regard to students, as indicated in (Wang, 2013), students from rural schools score lower on all the Internet inequality indicators (digital access, autonomy of use, social support, Internet use and self-efficacy) and are therefore more disadvantaged in Internet usage status than their urban peers. Several factors are affecting the smooth utilization of the internet especially in online class. These are being purported by the words from the participants.

Participant 6 mentioned that,

"The government should help on finding a solution to this problem, since most of us are using the Internet. They must provide a fast internet connection. Today, internet is necessary for the people because almost all things are in the Internet like Online Education and etc."

Students cannot do anything to improve their internet connection, as well as their school institutions. The government and the power that comes with it can change the way how the internet connection works in the Philippines. Governments need to work on lengthy actions or processes in solving this problem and provide the assistance they need to stay connected in the event of this crisis. For example, national accessibility pledges and rapport plans can help ensure connectivity in disaster situations.

Participant 3 mentioned that,

"For me I believe that the school should provide a strong internet connection such as WIFI for their students for them to be able to easily access when having an exam because I had experience one time that when I am in school, I am taking my exam and then I experience an error or low internet connection for I am just using a data."

Since the start of online learning, higher education institutions have made it their initiative to provide connectivity kits to their students taking Cebu

Technological University as an example. This higher education institution has provided its student's individual connectivity kits since the university shifted to online learning. But there is always a gap in terms of distribution. Some students who are freshmen did not receive the connectivity kit. Aside from that, the campus also experiences weak internet connection from time to time, which is a problem for both students and professors. It impedes scheduled online meetings, exams, and other activities.

This theme, The Impediment, highlights the factors seen as the cause of their internet connection not being at its favorable performance. In the general context of the Philippines, being in the bottom when it comes to internet speed, it comes as no surprise if students experience a lag in their internet connection. Even expected, these problems should not persist longer since people especially students need the internet now more than ever. One action HEI can take is seeking assistance from a telecommunications firm in order to obtain a reliable internet connection with Stronger than the Internet Connectivity: A Phenomenology an unlimited data plan that can cater to all students and other users. A temporary answer is nice but like any other problem, long-term solution is the best option and the only option students deserve.

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Theme 4: The Initiative

Learners should be open to developing and realizing whether a particular action is the right decision to take or whether a particular solution will address the problem or illuminate the issue amid the method of learning as part of the learning process (Bransford et al., 1999). The new modality of learning is not only unprecedented in nature but also takes a lot of adjustments for students. Along with this new set-up are the challenges they need to face and the problems they have to solve, thus, limitless resourcefulness should be practiced by students to cope with online education.

Participant 3 stated that,

"Honestly speaking, I don't have any actions to be taken of, I just only wait for the internet to be stable again."

When an internet connection is interrupted, students

must consider how to restore it. Some students, on the other hand, prefer to just wait for it to come back. It is this kind of situation where students feel hopeless because a lot of times, no matter what action they take they just could not make the internet connection stable. Moments like this often led to students wishing its face-to-face classes instead.

Participant 2 said that,

"Sometimes I will turn off the connection or my mobile data in order to refresh the signal connection. I also find a place where I can catch and have strong connections to internet."

On certain occasions where the internet is urgently needs such as during online meetings and exams, students really find options for their internet to be stable again after it is being interrupted. Often times they try refreshing the connection but then when one action is not enough, they are forced to travel and find a place where the internet is much more stable.

Participant 5 mentioned,

"I changed the Access Point Name (APN) and Network Mode from 4G to 3G or 2G right away."

Switching the network mode and APN might definitely assist to create a stronger and better internet connection because the internet connection can be quite sluggish at times. Students just have to try different ways to restore their internet connection. Some who are tech savvy opt for a more technical solution but for who aren't; they just have to find other ways.

Participant 9 said that,

"I always made sure to have an extra load in case there are emergencies. If my Wi-Fi signal is interrupted, I will automatically register a load to continue with my classes and activities."

Students who have experienced problems with their internet learned how to deal with unprecedented internet connection problems. As a student, being prepared for the future is a great endeavor. Some internet issues may arise at any time, but there is always another choice to utilize to continue studying.

Participant 6 said that,

"I'll talk to my teacher/professor about my problem. I'll explain to him/her those problems I have regarding

to my online class."

Inconvenience during online classes due to signal being interrupted seems to be a normal occurrence. This type of circumstances cannot be solved with interventions such as studying. Rather, it can only be solved by just waiting for the signal to come back or just communicating to the professors the problem. The latter option is one of the actions taken by students. In this way, students can also make way for their sentiments to be known and a certain action or some consideration is being extended by the professors.

Participant 2 stated that,

"I can't deny the fact that online class is very costly, wherein I always need to have load in order to utilize all platforms. I also have my brother which is also a college student and in order to solve this difficulty, I would approach to him that I will connect on his data and when his data expires, that's the time to reload my data and let him connect also."

Online learning is difficult, especially for students who do not have employment to support their financial demands, which would enable them to have access to the internet. This is a concern particularly if a student has a sibling who need internet access as well. Students might save money by sharing data connections.

Participant 3 mentioned that,

"Saving tips for data, like turning my mobile data whenever there is no necessary activities and classes to be attended or to be done."

Only utilize the data connection when it's needed. Turning it off might be really beneficial if one has taken the attempt to reduce data use. Use the internet for crucial purposes such as online classes, homework submissions, and for online meetings instead of scrolling for meaningless feeds on social media.

Participant 5 stated that,

"There are instances when I ran out of money to buy load. I used my extra money to buy ingredients to make buko juice and samalamig like gulaman to sell and earn money, and sometimes I buy things and then I sell them with an added 10 or 20 pesos from the original price."

Students that are strategic in their approach to learning

will be able to maintain and support their progress. Students who ran out of money to pay for an internet connection are very resourceful because they come up with a solution to this matter. There's always a way if there's a will.

Participant 9 said that,

"For me, the only way to handle this is to inform my parents about my situation. Since I can't get a job to supply my needs, I'll ask my parents for support. Luckily, I have supportive parents when it comes to academic problems so addressing my problems with connectivity issues won't be a problem."

Parents have a significant role in their children's education. While others are independently supporting their own education, a lot of students are being financially supported by their parents to sustain their studies online. Students require financial assistance from their parents in order to alleviate academic difficulties.

The Initiative theme accentuates the adaptability of students. Endless options have been tried just to solve the challenges they are facing when it comes to their education. It ranges from the technical resort to financial measures. These experiences and actions from the participants only strengthen the ability of these students to rise above circumstances and find a way to conquer any obstacle that hinders their goal. Technical, financial, and emotional support has to be there as they venture their journey towards learning.

Theme 5: The End Result

The end results show that the phenomenon of Internet connectivity affecting the students' school performance presented both positive and negative side. Students' instructional overall performance is aided by getting access to a PC and a web connection (Yesilyurt et al. 2014), which concluded that the good effects of the internet outnumber the negative effects.

The internet had helped students in this online learning set-up but sometimes due to low internet connectivity, this hinders or causes a delay of students' learning. This is based on the various experiences shared by the participants during the interview.

Participants 3 mentioned that,

"Yes, in ways that when I am in middle of listening the virtual discussion then suddenly there is a connection inconvenience. In some ways when I am also in the

verge of submitting my output and with the same the connection in sometimes is quite in trouble."

Online education involves both synchronous and asynchronous learning. Though asynchronous, activities assigned by professors need to be turned in online, and because of some internet issues, the possibility of not being able to turn them in on time is weighing on students' side. In the same manner, internet interruption during the asynchronous meeting is a big deal for a lot of students. A few moments of not being able to listen feel like they miss something important. These are the repercussions they need to face during this new normal of education.

Participant 9 stated that,

"I've experienced this lot and it made me anxious and frustrated at the same time for the reason that I am afraid that I would be left out by new information tackled during discussions."

Despite adapting to new modes of learning, students find online learning challenging for issues in terms of technology and even personally. Frustrations and anxiety can be the consequential emotions not being present during discussions if the internet connection doesn't permit it. Students are experiencing that repercussion of fear of not knowing new information discussed by their professors.

Participant 2 mentioned that,

"As an active student who is very serious about my study, it makes me feel sad knowing the fact that sometimes, I won't be able to participate or hear the discussions. I always wanted to attend my class and having this kind of problems, make me really sad and down."

These sentiments from the students give light to the circumstances that students are being affected by online learning psychologically. Despite the difficulties, students are still brave to conquer those just to continue their studies. In certain occasions where signal strength or lacks of thereof prove to be a problem, students cannot help but feel a certain level of disappointment and dejection. They feel that their effort would be gone to waste because sometimes no matter how active they maybe but the signal still obstructs that effort, it's no use.

Participant 9 mentioned that,

"In my overall experience in the new normal, the

internet connection positively affects my learning experience. New normal learning requires the internet for the discussions, activities, and online meetings. Without it, the new normal learning experiences won't be productive and convenient."

The internet has become the main player in education now that online learning is being utilized. It has opened a lot of possibilities for students and paves way for learning to take place even without the traditional set-up. Pursuing education online, in this point of time, is impossible without internet connectivity.

Participant 10 said that,

"There is a positive and negative side. The internet affects my academic performance positively because it easily to communicate to your teacher or other important purposes while the negative side is changing the way of communicating (negative effect on their verbal communication, and their way of writing)."

The Internet has both good and bad effects on students' academic performance; one of the good effects is the aid in communication to access education. It has become easy for students to communicate with their teachers, peers, or classmates. On the downside, students find it restricting to communicate online because they feel that it has altered the way they communicate verbally and even the way they compose their words in written form.

Participant 5 stated that,

"For me, I see internet connection negatively affecting the students' academic performance. I know that there are things that would benefit us from using it so, but most of the reasons are in favor of losing the interest of every student from the internet barriers."

Students benefited from the internet but clearly due to poor internet connection the student's interest in learning decreased. Slow internet connectivity causes a lot of concerns for students and eventually, these concerns turned into losing interest in their education. There are a lot of possibilities that can happen when the internet is interrupted and a lot of students feel like they miss a lot of significant opportunities.

The End Results theme educes relevance of internet connectivity in pursuit of education amid the health crisis. The internet, in general, is useful but how the slow internet connectivity can be a root of various obstructions in online learning. The various textural

languages drawn out from the horizons came to the conclusion that students in online classes indeed psychologically impacted, and felt frustrated, sad, anxious, and dejected when the internet connection is being interrupted. This situation calls for a need for improving infrastructure for faster connectivity and a call for everyone to be kind, students and professors alike.

Conclusion and Recommendation

The sudden unexpected shift from conventional to online learning has brought about the sphere of circumstances that influence how students take charge of their education amid a health crisis. This paper represents students who are dedicated to their studies and who continue to use personal and campus internet access to achieve academic success. The avidity and perseverance of students in their experience of poor internet connectivity in the new learning setup are mirrors of being valiant. Having poor internet connectivity is not a hindrance, where in fact, it continues to grow in importance for students as their RESOURCES and USAGE in both established and quasi-educational. Despite the IMPEDIMENTS they experienced in their online mode of learning, they still managed to TAKE INITIATIVE and resolve them. As an END OF RESULTS, the internet plays a vital role in this modality of learning. May these students' personal experiences inspire those students to be stronger than having poor internet connectivity.

Thus, it is recommended based on the findings of the study that students' management plans from the University can be construed in order to provide remedies to those students having poor internet connectivity. Above all, students with great dreams of success continue to fight and strive hard despite the challenges of internet connectivity because these obstacles are great helpers and motivators that will sharpen individual skills and perseverance for future endeavors.

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Affiliations and Corresponding Information

Mary Ann Bahinting

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Melca Ardiente

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Jenevic Endona

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Mary Abiguel Herapat

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Darell Lambo

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Hanalyn Joy Librea

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Marianne Claire Librando

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Jean Bernadette Libron

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Mary Jolina Petaluna

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Gracelyn Ygot

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Jingoy Taneo

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Cyril Cabello, PhD(c)

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Dr. Antonieta Minyamin

Cebu Technological University
Moalboal Campus, Philippines

Table 1. *Data Analysis*

Horizon	Textural language	Theme
Google, YouTube because there, I can learn almost anything in this video platform. I also visit the website of Khan Academy, Wikipedia, and as a math major, I make use of dismays graphing calculator because one of our professors encourage us to use it, to check if our answer is correct and at the same time, in terms of research, I make use of Google scholar. (P10#1) Gadgets such as cellular phones, laptop and computers are some of my internet resources I use. (P6#1)	Utilization of software Gadget as main source	The Resources
It is quite important since we are in a new educational set-up which is the online platform of learning, so internet plays an important role for me as student to attend classes and to dig deep more about a certain topic and more that relates to this matter. (P3#6) I use the internet to search for study-related materials; assignments, quizzes, and presentations; all study-related materials are available on the internet; and because of the internet, online education is possible.	Significant role of internet in online education The Internet makes studying from home possible.	The Usage

Students like me can stay on our comfort places because online classes allow us to study from home with relative ease. (P5#6)

As a student in this new normal, internet connectivity plays a very important role because during discussion, it helps me to participate especially those professors who conduct oral discussion whom he/she gives points those who can participate. (P10#6)

*Oral
participation
online*

The government should help on finding a solution to this problem, since most of us are using the Internet. They must provide a fast internet connection. Today, internet is necessary for the people because almost all things are in the Internet like Online Education and etc.(P6#4)

***Government's role in
improving internet
speed***

The Impediment

For me I believe that the school should provide strong internet connection such as WIFI for their students for them to be able to easily access when having an exam because I had experience one time that when I am in school, I am taking my exam and then I experience an error or low internet

***Institution's role for
students to have a
good internet***

*connection for I am
just using a data.*

*For me, the only way
to handle this is to
inform my parents
about my situation.
Since I can't get a job
to supply my needs, I'll
ask my parents for
support. Luckily, I
have supportive
parents when it comes
to academic problems
so addressing my
problems with
connectivity issues
won't be a problem.
(P9#9)*

*Communicating the
inconvenience*

***The
initiative***

*I can't deny the fact
that online class is
very costly, wherein I
always need to have
load in order to utilize
all platforms. I also
have my brother which
is also a college
student and in order to
solve this difficulty, I
would approach to him
that I will connect on
his data and when his
data expires, that's the
time to reload my data
and let him connect
also. (P2#9)*

Burden of internet cost

*I changed the Access
Point Name (APN) and
Network Mode from
4Gto3G or 2G right
away. (P5#7)*

*Economizing internet
connectivity*

*I always made sure to
have a next reload in
case there are
emergencies. If my Wi-
Fi signal is*

*Resourcefulness to
finance internet*

*interrupted, I will connectivity
automatically register
a load to continue with
my classes and
activities. (P9#7)*

The End of Results

*Honestly speaking, I
don't have any actions
to be taken of; I just
only wait for the
internet to be stable
again. (P3#7)*

Hopeless Waiting

*Sometimes I will turn
off the connection or
my mobile data in
order to refresh the
signal connection. I
also find a place where
I can catch and have
strong connections to
internet. (P2#7)*

*Hoping from one place
to another*

*I've experienced this
lot and it made me
anxious and frustrated
at the same time for the
reason that I am afraid
that I would be left out
by new information
tackled during
discussions. (P9#8)*

*Anxiety of being left
out*

*As an active student
who is very serious
about my study, it
makes me feel sad
knowing the fact that
sometimes, I won't be
able to participate or
hear the discussions. I
always wanted to
attend my class and
having this kind of
problems, make me
really sad and down.
(P2#8)*

*Dejection for lost
opportunity*

*Yes, in ways that when
I am in middle of*

*Troubled on delayed
submissions of outputs*

listening the virtual discussion then suddenly there is a connection in convenience. In some ways when I am also in the verge of submitting my output and with the same the connection in sometimes is quite in trouble. (P3#5)

In my overall experience in the new normal, the internet connection positively affects my learning experience. New normal learning requires the internet for the discussions, activities, and online meetings. Without it, the new normal learning experiences won't be productive and convenient. (P9#10)

Productivity and Convenience of online class

Bilateral Impacts

There is a positive and negative side. The internet affects my academic performance positively because it easily to communicate to your teacher or other important purposes while the negative side is changing the way of communicating (negative effect on their verbal communication, and their way of writing). (P10#6)

Losing interest due to connectivity barriers

For me, I see internet connection negatively affecting the students' academic performance. I know

*that there are things
that would benefit us
from using It so, but
most of the reasons are
in favor of losing the
interest of every
student from the
internet barriers.
(P5#10)*
